Page 1: Title

Title retained. Source manuscript has no final title-page copy.

Original

Finding Our Inner Voice

[Final title-page layout pending.]

Your notes

Proposed (unchanged)

Finding Our Inner Voice

[Final title-page layout pending.]

Your notes

Page 2: Blank

Blank page retained in both editions.

Original

(Intentionally blank.)

Proposed (unchanged)

(Intentionally blank.)

Your notes

Your notes

Page 3: Dedication

Customer dedication retained. No dedication message supplied for this review.

Original

[Customer dedication message]

[Final dedication layout pending.]

Proposed (unchanged)

[Customer dedication message]

[Final dedication layout pending.]

Your notes

Your notes

Page 4: Blank

Blank page retained in both editions.

Original

(Intentionally blank.)

Your notes

Proposed (unchanged)

(Intentionally blank.)

Your notes

Page 5: Park arrival

Copy unchanged in this draft.

Original

27 words

This was [Child Name]'s favorite park in all of [Hometown].

Swings squeaked.
Sneakers thumped.
Kids laughed and called, "Again, again!"

[Child Name] ran in, ready to play.

Your notes

Proposed (unchanged)

27 words

This was [Child Name]'s favorite park in all of [Hometown].

Swings squeaked.
Sneakers thumped.
Kids laughed and called, "Again, again!"

[Child Name] ran in, ready to play.

Your notes

Page 6: Park choices

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

36 words

There were swings,
tunnels,
sand,
and a climbing wall that looked almost like a mountain.

[Child Name] looked left.
[Child Name] looked right.

"What should I try first?"

Then came a whoosh from way up high.

Proposed

28 words

Swings.
Tunnels.
Sand.
A climbing wall like a mountain.

[Child Name] looked left, then right.
"What should I try first?"

Then came a whoosh from way up high.

Your notes

Your notes

Page 7: The tall slide

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

37 words

It was the tall slide.

Kids climbed up.
Kids sat down.
Kids whooshed all the way to the bottom.

"Again, again!" they shouted.

[Child Name] looked up.

The slide looked fun.
It also looked very, very tall.

Proposed

24 words

The tall slide!

Kids climbed up,
sat down,
and whooshed to the bottom.

"Again, again!"

[Child Name] looked up.
Fun.
But very, very tall.

Your notes

Your notes

Page 8: At the top

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

44 words

[Child Name] climbed to the top.

From up there, the slide looked longer than it did from the ground.

"Your turn!"
"Go!"
"It's fun!"

[Child Name]'s tummy flipped.
The top felt small.
The slide felt big.

[Child Name] did not know what to do.

Proposed

32 words

[Child Name] climbed to the top.

The slide looked even longer from here.

"Your turn!"
"Go!"
"It's fun!"

[Child Name]'s tummy flipped.

The top felt small.
The slide felt big.

What now?

Your notes

Your notes

Page 9: Sad bedroom and first tiny voice

Original is the previously reviewed combined bedroom copy. Right column is a new suggestion.

Original

62 words

That night, [Child Name] sat quietly on the bed.
The slide was far away now.
But the big feeling was still there.

"Your turn!" "Go!" "It's fun!"
The voices bounced around in [Child Name]'s mind.

[Child Name] took a deep breath.
The room got quiet.

"That was scary," said a tiny voice.
[Child Name] nodded. "Yes."

"Oh! You can hear me now."

Proposed

49 words

That night, [Child Name] sat quietly on the bed.
The slide was far away.
The big feeling was still there.

"Your turn!" "Go!" "It's fun!"

[Child Name] took a deep breath.
The room grew quiet.

"That was scary," said a tiny voice.
"Yes."

"Oh! You can hear me now."

Your notes

Your notes

Page 10: Bedroom light trail and gradual forest transition

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

33 words

"Who said that?" asked [Child Name].

A tiny light blinked beside the bed.
Then another.
Then another.

The lights made a little path across the floor.

"Let's look together," said the tiny voice.

Proposed

31 words

"Who said that?" asked [Child Name].

A light blinked beside the bed.
Then another.
Then another.

The lights made a path across the floor.
"Let's look together," said the tiny voice.

Your notes

Your notes

Page 11: Bedroom light trail and gradual forest transition

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

35 words

[Child Name] followed the little lights.

The bedroom grew soft at the edges.
The walls became trees.
The rug became moss.
The ceiling filled with stars.

"This way," said the tiny voice.
"Whenever you're ready."

Proposed

26 words

[Child Name] followed the lights.

The walls became trees.
The rug became moss.
The ceiling filled with stars.

"This way," said the voice.
"Whenever you're ready."

Your notes

Your notes

Page 12: Footprints lead along path toward bush

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

32 words

The lights led [Child Name] onto a quiet path.

In the middle was a little clue:
[animal clue].

[Child Name] looked left.
[Child Name] looked right.

"Where are you?" called [Child Name].

Proposed

21 words

On the quiet path lay a clue:
[animal clue].

[Child Name] looked left.
Then right.

"Where are you?" called [Child Name].

Your notes

Your notes

Page 13: Footprints lead along path toward bush

Copy unchanged in this draft.

Original

24 words

Something rustled in a bush.

"Are you hiding?" asked [Child Name].

The bush rustled again.

Then it sneezed.

"Achoo!"

Bushes do not usually sneeze.

Your notes

Proposed (unchanged)

24 words

Something rustled in a bush.

"Are you hiding?" asked [Child Name].

The bush rustled again.

Then it sneezed.

"Achoo!"

Bushes do not usually sneeze.

Your notes

Page 14: Chaos, breathing vignette, and quiet path

Breathing-vignette placement across pages 14 and 15 still needs review against the pose map.

Original

43 words

Before [Child Name] could peek behind the bush,
the stars started blinking in every direction.

"This way!" blinked one.
"No, this way!" puffed the wind.
"Hop!" said a mushroom.
"Skip!" said a stone.

Then a sign spun around and around.

"HURRY!" it pointed.

Your notes

Proposed

34 words

Before [Child Name] could peek,
voices called from every direction.

"This way!" blinked a star.
"No, this way!" puffed the wind.
"Hop!" said a mushroom.
"Skip!" said a stone.

A sign spun around.
"HURRY!"

Your notes

Page 15: Chaos, breathing vignette, and quiet path

Breathing-vignette placement across pages 14 and 15 still needs review against the pose map.

Original

49 words

"Too many voices can make it hard
to know what feels right," the voice said.

So [Child Name] stopped and took one slow breath.

[Child Name] listened
for the small, true voice inside.

"Listen close," said the tiny voice.
"I'm still here."

And there it was:
a quiet path.

Proposed

32 words

"Too many voices make it hard to hear your own,"
said the tiny voice.

[Child Name] stopped.
One slow breath.

"Listen close. I'm still here."

And there it was:
a quiet path.

Your notes

Your notes

Page 16: Path choice

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

52 words

The quiet path split in two.

One way was smooth and shiny.
It looked easy.

The other way was plain and steep.

[Child Name] looked at the shiny path.
It was pretty.

But something inside felt tight.

[Child Name] took a deep breath and listened.

"Not that way," whispered the tiny voice.

Proposed

41 words

The path split in two.

One way was smooth and shiny.
It looked easy.
The other was plain and steep.

[Child Name] looked at the shiny path.
Something inside felt tight.

A deep breath.
"Not that way," whispered the tiny voice.

Your notes

Your notes

Page 17: Cave approach

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

28 words

[Child Name] chose the steep path.

The path climbed up,
and up,
and up.

At the top was a cave.

The cave glittered inside.
[Child Name] stepped closer.

Proposed

21 words

[Child Name] chose the steep path.

Up,
and up,
and up.

At the top, a cave glittered.
[Child Name] stepped closer.

Your notes

Your notes

Page 18: Prickly words

Capitalized cave-wall phrases also appear in the art. Review whether story text should repeat them.

Original

39 words

A wall blocked the path.

On it were big, prickly words:

YOU CAN'T!
YOU'RE TOO LITTLE!

The friendly voice sounded different now.

"YOU CAN'T! YOU CAN'T!"
it echoed through the cave.

"Why do you sound mean?" asked [Child Name].

Proposed

28 words

A wall blocked the path.
Big, prickly words shouted:

YOU CAN'T!
YOU'RE TOO LITTLE!

The friendly voice sounded sharp now.

"Why do you sound mean?" asked [Child Name].

Your notes

Your notes

Page 19: Words soften

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

30 words

The voice did not answer right away.

[Child Name] remembered what helped before.

One deep breath,
then another.

The cave grew quieter.

The prickly words began to wiggle.
Then soften.

Proposed

22 words

The voice was quiet.

[Child Name] remembered.
One deep breath.
Then another.

The cave grew quieter.
The prickly words wiggled.
Then softened.

Your notes

Your notes

Page 20: Hidden feeling

Capitalized cave-wall phrases also appear in the art. Review whether story text should repeat them.

Original

32 words

The words opened.

Inside were smaller words:

I'M A LITTLE SCARED.

THIS FEELS TOO BIG.

"Oh," said [Child Name].
"You were not trying to be mean."

The tiny voice felt warm again.

Proposed

28 words

The words opened.
Inside were smaller words:

I'M A LITTLE SCARED.
THIS FEELS TOO BIG.

"Oh. You weren't trying to be mean."

The tiny voice felt warm again.

Your notes

Your notes

Page 21: Understanding

Copy unchanged in this draft.

Original

24 words

"Sometimes big feelings come out sharp,"
said the voice.

"But if you listen close,
you can hear what they are really trying to say."

Your notes

Proposed (unchanged)

24 words

"Sometimes big feelings come out sharp,"
said the voice.

"But if you listen close,
you can hear what they are really trying to say."

Your notes

Page 22: Cave opens

Copy unchanged in this draft.

Original

21 words

The prickles fell away.
The wall shimmered.
The cave opened wide.

Beyond it, the world was bright.

[Child Name] stepped through.

Your notes

Proposed (unchanged)

21 words

The prickles fell away.
The wall shimmered.
The cave opened wide.

Beyond it, the world was bright.

[Child Name] stepped through.

Your notes

Page 23: Into sunlight

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

51 words

[Child Name] ran into the sunlight.

The tight feeling was not so tight now.

[Child Name] knew what the tiny voice was for.

It helped [object pronoun] know
what felt scary,
what felt wrong,
and what felt right.

When [Child Name] listened close,
the big feeling did not feel so big.

Proposed

31 words

[Child Name] ran into the sunlight.
The tight feeling eased.

Now [Child Name] understood.
The tiny voice helped [object pronoun] notice
what felt scary,
what felt wrong,
and what felt right.

Your notes

Your notes

Page 24: Final clue trail

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

50 words

"I want to see you," said [Child Name].

A trail of [animal clues] glowed ahead.

[Child Name] followed them deeper
into the magical forest.

The forest grew warmer.
The path grew quieter.

"Where did you go?" whispered [Child Name].

"Listen close," said the tiny voice.
"That quiet is your heart."

Your notes

Proposed

35 words

"I want to see you," said [Child Name].

A trail of [animal clues] glowed ahead.
The forest grew warmer and quieter.

"Where are you?"

"Listen close," said the tiny voice.
"That quiet is your heart."

Your notes

Page 25: Animal reveal

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

48 words

[Child Name] came to a clearing.

Warm magic swirled through the air.

[animal guide] appeared.

[Child Name] gasped.

"It was you?"

[animal guide] smiled.

"I am the quiet voice inside you,"
said [animal guide],
"in a shape you can see."

The warm quiet was inside [Child Name], too.

Proposed

36 words

In a warm, magical clearing,
[animal guide] appeared.

[Child Name] gasped.
"It was you?"

"I am your quiet voice,"
said [animal guide],
"in a shape you can see."

The warm quiet was inside [Child Name], too.

Your notes

Your notes

Page 26: Flying home

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

40 words

The dream lifted.

[Child Name] and [animal guide] flew through the stars.

Below them, the magical forest grew small.

Ahead was the park,
the ladder,
and the very, very tall slide.

[animal guide] stayed close.

So did the quiet voice.

Proposed

36 words

[Child Name] and [animal guide]
flew through the stars.

The magical forest grew small below.
Ahead was the park,
the ladder,
and the very, very tall slide.

The guide stayed close.
So did the quiet voice.

Your notes

Your notes

Page 27: Back at the top

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

45 words

[Child Name] was back at the top.

The slide still looked long.
The slide still looked fun.
The slide still looked very, very tall.

"Your turn!"
"Go!"
"It's fun!"

[Child Name]'s tummy flipped.

This time, [Child Name] knew what to do.

Pause.
Breathe.
Listen close.

Your notes

Proposed

36 words

Back at the top,
the slide still looked fun.
It still looked very, very tall.

"Your turn!"
"Go!"
"It's fun!"

[Child Name]'s tummy flipped.
This time, [Child Name] knew what to do.

Pause.
Breathe.
Listen close.

Your notes

Page 28: Almost ready

Draft suggestions for your review.

Original

38 words

The quiet voice was there.

Small and warm.

"Not yet," it said.
"Almost."

[Child Name] looked at the child waiting behind [object pronoun].

"You go first," said [Child Name].
"I'm almost ready."

And this time,
[Child Name] smiled.

Proposed

33 words

The quiet voice was there.
Small and warm.

"Not yet. Almost."

[Child Name] turned to the child waiting behind [object pronoun].

"You go first. I'm almost ready."

And this time, [Child Name] smiled.

Your notes

Your notes

Page 29: Blank

Blank page retained in both editions.

Original

(Intentionally blank.)

Your notes

Proposed (unchanged)

(Intentionally blank.)

Your notes

Page 30: Listening exercise

Copy unchanged in this draft.

Original

36 words

Pause.
Breathe.
Listen close.

Trace the spiral with your finger.

Breathe in as you go around.
Breathe out as you come back.

Then ask inside:

Is there a tiny no?
A not yet?
A little yes?

Your notes

Proposed (unchanged)

36 words

Pause.
Breathe.
Listen close.

Trace the spiral with your finger.

Breathe in as you go around.
Breathe out as you come back.

Then ask inside:

Is there a tiny no?
A not yet?
A little yes?

Your notes

Page 31: About and copyright

Planning placeholder only. About text, copyright details, and parent prompt remain to finalize.

Original (planning placeholder)

About Little Hero Labs / copyright page.

Possible parent prompt:

Can you remember a tiny no,
a not yet,
or a little yes?

Your notes

Proposed (unchanged) (planning placeholder)

About Little Hero Labs / copyright page.

Possible parent prompt:

Can you remember a tiny no,
a not yet,
or a little yes?

Your notes

Page 32: Blank

Blank page retained in both editions.

Original

(Intentionally blank.)

Proposed (unchanged)

(Intentionally blank.)

Your notes

Your notes